Kitchen Risk Assessments & Staff Rules

The Vedanta Kitchen & Retreat Centre
Branston Hall, Lincoln Road, Branston, Lincoln LN4 1PD

Assessor	Shyam Prasad
Documents	11
Printed edition	October 2026

Contents

No.	Document	Page
01	Risk Assessment – Staff Kitchen Access & Rules	3
02	Risk Assessment – Thermomix TM6	10
03	Risk Assessment – Caso Ice Creamer	12
04	Risk Assessment – Ninja Hand Blender	14
05	Risk Assessment – KitchenAid Professional Stand Mixer	16
06	Risk Assessment – Waring Stick Blender	18
07	Risk Assessment – Knives, Mandoline, Slicers & Peelers	20
08	Risk Assessment – Vedanta Kitchen	22
09	Risk Assessment – Vedanta Catering Services	24
10	Risk Assessment – Front of House & Kitchen	26
11	Risk Assessment – Generic Kitchen (June 2024 basis)	28

Risk Assessment – Staff Kitchen Access & Rules

The Vedanta Way Limited – The Vedanta Kitchen & Retreat Centre
Branston Hall, Lincoln Road, Branston, Lincoln LN4 1PD – https://thevedanta.org/

Applies to	Kitchen staff · Restaurant / FOH staff · Building & Ground staff – anyone entering the kitchen, fridge, freezer, dry store or portable cabin.
Assessor	Shyam Prasad
Date	27 June 2026 (cover) – NOTE: the assessment table below states 27 July 2026; date to be confirmed.
Review due	27 June 2027 (cover) – the table states 27 July 2027.

WHO THIS PACK IS FOR

Workplace	The Vedanta Kitchen & Retreat Centre — Branston Hall, LN4 1PD
Company	The Vedanta Way Limited
Assessor	Shyam Prasad
Assessment date	27 July 2026
Review date	27 July 2027, or sooner after an incident / near miss / layout change
People covered	Kitchen team; restaurant / FOH / service staff; housekeeping; maintenance; office / building staff; contractors; any visitor entering food areas
Areas covered	Main kitchen, pass/service area, fridge, freezer, dry store, portable cabin, corridors linked to kitchen, buffet / hot-holding collection points

Anyone who is not working a full kitchen shift still creates risk when they enter the kitchen to collect food, check stock, clean, repair, or walk through. This pack sets one clear standard for all departments.

MANDATORY PPE BEFORE ENTERING THE KITCHEN

No person may enter the kitchen food area without the following:

1. Anti-slip / non-slip health & safety footwear — mandatory. No open sandals, flip-flops or smooth soles.
2. Hair net — all hair must be fully covered. Long hair secured under the net.
3. Chef’s tissue / neck tissue (or site-approved disposable alternative) when entering the kitchen.
4. Clean apron or designated kitchen outerwear if provided / required for the task.
5. Remove loose jewellery, dangling lanyards and scarves that can catch on equipment.
6. Wash or sanitise hands before touching food, trays, utensils or storage shelves.

DO:

- Wear anti-slip shoes every time
- Cover hair fully with a hair net
- Wear chef’s tissue when entering the kitchen
- Wash / sanitise hands before touching food or trays

DON'T:

- Don't enter in open shoes or smooth soles
- Don't leave hair uncovered
- Don't wear outdoor coats over food-contact work
- Don't touch food with unwashed hands

CARE:

- Keep spare hair nets and tissues near the kitchen entrance
- Replace damaged PPE immediately
- Managers enforce the PPE gate — no exceptions for "quick visits"

RESTAURANT & FRONT OF HOUSE – KITCHEN ACCESS STEPS

Restaurant and FOH staff often enter to collect plated food, buffet gastronorm trays, drinks support items, or stock. Follow these steps every time:

1. Put on anti-slip shoes, hair net and chef's tissue before entering.
2. Pause at the door — look and listen. If the line is busy, wait or ask the chef before crossing.
3. Watch the floor for water, oil, food spill or wet-floor signs.
4. Keep clear of chefs' knife work and prep boards; never reach across a cutting board.
5. Stay away from open oven doors, hot ranges and fryers — steam and oil splash burn quickly.
6. Use only agreed routes to the pass, fridge, freezer, dry store or cabin.
7. When collecting hot trays / buffet items, use dry heat-proof cloths (see next section).
8. If you used any equipment, board or knife — clean as you go and put everything back (see Clean as you go section).
9. Leave promptly, keep walkways clear, and report any spill, out-of-date food or unsafe practice.

MOVING SAFELY AROUND THE KITCHEN

Kitchen hazards for anyone walking through:

- Wet, greasy or oily floors — high slip risk near sinks, dishwash, fryers and pass.
- Chefs carrying knives, hot pans or trays — call "behind", "hot", "sharp" and give way.
- Ovens on — doors may open suddenly with steam and radiant heat.
- Fryers in use — oil splash, hot zone around the fryer, never rush past.
- Trailing cables, trolleys, crates and bin bags in corridors.
- Fridge / freezer doors swinging into walkways.
- Noise and distraction — do not use phones while moving through the cook line.

DO:

- Walk, don't run
- Keep left / use agreed routes
- Call out when passing ("behind", "hot")
- Wipe or report spills immediately

DON'T:

- Don't cut through the hot cook line unless required
- Don't stop to chat in doorways or at the pass
- Don't carry more than you can see over

- Don’t ignore wet-floor signs

CARE:

- Expect the unexpected — ovens, fryers and knives move fast
- If unsure, wait for a kitchen team member to guide you
- Near-misses must be reported the same day

CLEAN AS YOU GO – LEAVE THE KITCHEN PROFESSIONAL

If restaurant staff, house staff, FOH, kitchen team or anyone else uses the kitchen — even for a short task — they must clean as they go. The kitchen must be left professional, tidy and ready for the next person. Do not leave chopping boards, knives, peelers, pans, utensils or equipment behind dirty or out of place.

Clean-as-you-go steps (everyone):

1. Finish your food task first, then clean immediately — do not walk away “for later”.
2. Wash or sanitise knives, peelers and utensils you used; dry them.
3. Wash chopping boards (correct colour board for the food type) and stand them to dry or return clean.
4. Wipe the worktop, sink edge and any spills on the floor you caused.
5. Return knives and peelers to the designated drawer; return other equipment to its correct place.
6. Never leave a dirty board, knife, blender shaft, pan or tray on the side for someone else to clear.
7. If you used a fridge, freezer, dry store or cabin — close doors, wipe drips, put stock back neatly.
8. Check the area looks professional before you leave. If you are unsure how to clean a piece of equipment, ask the chef — do not abandon it dirty.

DO:

- Clean boards, knives and tools straight after use
- Put everything back in the correct place / drawer
- Wipe worktops and floor spills you made
- Leave the kitchen tidy for the next person

DON’T:

- Don’t leave chopping boards or knives on the side
- Don’t leave dirty equipment for kitchen staff to clear
- Don’t walk away mid-task without cleaning
- Don’t put wet knives loose and jumbled in the drawer

CARE:

- Clean as you go is mandatory for every department using the kitchen
- A professional kitchen stays ready for service at all times
- Managers may stop kitchen access for staff who repeatedly leave mess behind

HOT GASTRONORM TRAYS, BUFFET & SERVICE COLLECTION

Restaurant staff collecting food for buffet / service often handle hot gastronorm (GN) trays. Bare hands on hot trays cause burns; rushing with hot trays on wet floors causes slips and scalds.

1. Confirm the tray is ready with the kitchen / pass before lifting.

2. Use dry heat-proof cloths or oven gloves — never wet cloths (steam burns) and never bare hands.
3. Check lids are secure; beware of hot condensate under lids.
4. Lift with two hands; keep the tray level; do not stack unstable hot loads.
5. Announce “hot coming through” on the route to the buffet / service point.
6. Walk carefully — if the floor is wet or oily, ask for the route to be cleared or dried first.
7. Set trays onto a stable stand / Bain-marie / buffet well — not on an unstable edge.
8. If a tray is too heavy or too hot, stop and ask for help. Do not struggle alone.

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Burns from hot GN trays / lids	Restaurant / FOH / kitchen staff	Mandatory dry heat-proof cloths or gloves; two-hand lift; announce hot; training before unsupervised collection.	**High** before → **Low** after
Slip/trip while carrying hot food	Restaurant / FOH staff; nearby guests/ staff	Anti-slip shoes; clear route; no rushing; wipe spills; don’t carry overloaded stacks.	**High** before → **Low** after
Scald from hot liquids spilling from tray	Carrier and people nearby	Level carry; secure lids; don’t overfill; keep guests clear of route.	**High** before → **Low** after

FRIDGE, FREEZER, DRY STORE & PORTABLE CABIN

Staff entering cold storage, dry store or the portable cabin must protect food safety as well as personal safety.

1. Wear required PPE before entry (anti-slip shoes, hair net, chef’s tissue).
2. Open doors carefully — watch for people on the other side and icy / wet floors.
3. Do not leave fridge or freezer doors open longer than needed.
4. Check use-by / best-before dates before taking or returning products.
5. Do not use out-of-date, damaged, unlabelled or unclean packaging — report it.
6. Keep raw and ready-to-eat foods separate; never place raw above ready-to-eat.
7. Maintain cleanliness: wipe drips, report dirty shelves, pests, bad smells or broken seals.
8. In the portable cabin: secure the door, keep stock tidy, switch lights off if required, report damage.
9. Wash / sanitise hands after handling outer packaging before touching ready-to-eat food.

DO:

- Check expiry dates every time
- Close fridge/freezer doors promptly
- Keep storage clean and organised
- Report damaged / out-of-date stock

DON’T:

- Don’t leave doors propped open
- Don’t store personal food with kitchen stock
- Don’t ignore spills or unclean shelves
- Don’t use unlabelled containers

CARE:

- Cold chain and allergen control protect guests
- If in doubt, ask the chef / kitchen manager before using stock
- Cabin and dry store are still food areas — same hygiene rules apply

BUILDING / MAINTENANCE / OTHER VISITING STAFF

Housekeeping, maintenance, contractors and other building staff may enter for repairs, deliveries, cleaning or inspections. Extra controls apply because they may be unfamiliar with kitchen flow.

1. Report to the kitchen manager / chef in charge before starting work.
2. Wear anti-slip shoes, hair net and chef's tissue (and any additional PPE for the task).
3. Stay only in the agreed work area; do not walk the cook line unless escorted.
4. Do not touch food, prep surfaces, ovens, fryers or knives unless authorised and trained.
5. Protect food from dust, tools and chemicals — cover or remove food first if needed.
6. Clean as you go; remove tools and waste before leaving — never leave boards, knives or equipment dirty.
7. If cooking is live, wait for a safe window — never distract a chef mid-task at hot equipment.

KITCHEN STAFF REMINDERS

Kitchen team members remain responsible for warning visitors and keeping routes as safe as practical during service.

- Call "hot", "behind", "sharp", "oven opening", "fryer" clearly.
- Do not leave knives on the edge of boards or pointing into walkways.
- Close oven doors when not actively loading/unloading.
- Mop oil/water promptly and use wet-floor signs.
- Help FOH lift awkward hot GN trays when asked.
- Challenge anyone entering without anti-slip shoes, hair net or chef's tissue.
- Keep fridge/freezer/dry store/cabin organised so visiting staff can find items safely.
- Remind restaurant / house staff: clean as you go — do not leave boards, knives or equipment behind.
- Do not accept a hand-over of dirty prep areas from visiting departments — ask them to finish cleaning first.

1. Risk assessment table — staff kitchen access

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Entering kitchen without anti-slip shoes	All visiting / kitchen staff	Mandatory anti-slip footwear policy; refuse entry if not worn; spare pairs available if site policy allows.	**High** before → **Low** after
Hair / clothing contamination of food	Guests / food handlers	Hair net mandatory; chef's tissue; clean apron; remove loose jewellery; hand hygiene.	**High** before → **Low** after
Slips on wet / oily floors	All staff in kitchen	Anti-slip shoes; clean-as-you-go; wet-floor signs; no running; report spills.	**High** before → **Low** after
Contact with knives / being cut while passing	FOH / visitors / kitchen	Keep clear of prep; chefs announce sharp; knives stored safely after use; no reaching across boards.	**High** before → **Low** after

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Burns / scalds from ovens, steam, fryers	Anyone near cook line	Stand clear of oven doors and fryers; chefs announce opening; visitors use agreed routes only.	**High** before → **Low** after
Burns from hot buffet / GN trays	Restaurant / FOH staff	Heat-proof cloths/gloves required; two-hand method; training; ask for help with heavy/ hot loads.	**High** before → **Low** after
Collision with chef carrying hot items	All staff	Call-outs; keep-left; no stopping in pass; limit congestion during service.	Medium before → **Low** after
Using out-of-date / unclean stock from fridge/freezer/ store/cabin	Guests (food safety) / staff	Check dates every time; report unclean or damaged stock; FIFO; manager checks.	**High** before → **Low** after
Cold-store door / icy floor injury	Anyone entering cold rooms	Anti-slip shoes; open carefully; keep floors dry; do not rush; close doors properly.	Medium before → **Low** after
Untrained building staff distracting cooks / touching equipment	Kitchen team / visitors	Report in first; escort if needed; agreed work window; no unauthorised equipment use.	**High** before → **Low** after
Leaving dirty boards, knives or equipment behind after use	All staff using kitchen; next users; guests (hygiene)	Mandatory clean as you go; wash and return tools; wipe surfaces; managers enforce professional leave-behind standard.	**High** before → **Low** after

1. Emergency & reporting

- Burns/scalds: cool under lukewarm running water for at least 20 minutes; seek first aid; call 999 for serious burns.
- Cuts: apply pressure with a clean dressing; seek first aid; do not continue food handling with an uncovered wound.
- Slips/falls: do not move a seriously injured person; call first aid / 999 as needed; secure the area.
- Food safety concern (out-of-date, contamination, allergen doubt): stop use, isolate product, tell the kitchen manager immediately.
- All accidents and near misses must be recorded the same day.

1. Department acknowledgement sign-off

I confirm I have read and understood this Staff Kitchen Access Risk Assessment, including mandatory anti-slip shoes, hair net, chef’s tissue, safe movement, hot tray handling, fridge/freezer/dry store/cabin rules, and clean as you go (never leave boards, knives or equipment dirty). I will follow these controls whenever I enter or use the kitchen.

Department copies to issue

- Kitchen team
- Restaurant / Front of House / service team
- Housekeeping
- Maintenance / facilities
- Office / building management
- Any contractor working in or through the kitchen

(Sign-off table: Name / Department / role / Signature / Date — complete on the printed copy.)

Document by	Shyam Prasad
Approved by	—
Approval date	—
Version	1.1 Staff Kitchen Access Pack — includes clean as you go
Related document	Vedanta_Kitchen_Safety_Brochure_Risk_Pack.docx (equipment only)

STAFF SIGN-OFF – I HAVE READ AND UNDERSTOOD THIS ASSESSMENT

#	Name	Signature	Date
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

Risk Assessment – Thermomix TM6

Source	Vedanta Combined Equipment & Kitchen Risk Assessments pack, v1.0 (document owner Shyam Prasad).
DATE NOTE	the source gives Date Completed 25/07/2026 and Review Date 04/11/2025 – the review date is before the completion date and needs correcting by the assessor.

EQUIPMENT INFORMATION

Location	The Vedanta Kitchen & Retreat Centre
Assessor	Shyam Prasad
Brand	Thermomix
Model	TM6
Date Completed	25/07/2026
Review Date	04/11/2025 (see date note)

DESCRIPTION OF EQUIPMENT

A multi-function cooking appliance used for chopping, blending, cooking, steaming, kneading and precise heating. Used for soups, sauces, doughs, purees and prepared dishes in bakery and catering production.

OPERATING PROCEDURE (HOW TO USE)

1. Place the Thermomix on a stable, dry, level work surface with adequate ventilation around the base.
2. Ensure the mixing bowl is correctly seated and locked before use.
3. Fit the correct blade or accessory for the task and secure the lid and measuring cup as required.
4. Select the appropriate mode, temperature and speed for the recipe; do not exceed recommended fill levels.
5. Keep hands, utensils and cloths away from the blade area while the machine is running.
6. Allow hot contents to settle before opening the lid; open away from the face to avoid steam.
7. Use the spatula only through the lid opening when the manufacturer instructions allow.
8. Switch off and unplug before changing accessories, emptying the bowl or cleaning.
9. Clean food-contact parts thoroughly after each use and follow HACCP hygiene controls.

RISK ASSESSMENT

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Blade contact / finger injury	Staff	Never reach into the bowl while powered; lock lid; unplug before removing blade.	**High** before → **Low** after
Steam / hot liquid burns	Staff	Use correct temperature settings; open lid carefully; use oven cloths for hot bowls.	**High** before → **Low** after
Electrical shock	Staff	Inspect cable and base; keep area dry; unplug before cleaning.	Medium before → **Low** after

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Splash / ejection of hot contents	Staff	Do not overfill; use measuring cup; start at low speed for hot liquids.	Medium before → **Low** after
Food contamination	Guests / Staff	Clean and sanitise bowl, lid and blade; separate raw and ready-to-eat use; follow HACCP.	**High** before → **Low** after

REQUIRED PPE

- Apron
- Non-slip footwear
- Heat-resistant gloves or cloths when handling hot bowls / steam

STAFF SIGN-OFF – I HAVE READ AND UNDERSTOOD THIS ASSESSMENT

#	Name	Signature	Date
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

Risk Assessment – Caso Ice Creamer

Source	Vedanta Combined Equipment & Kitchen Risk Assessments pack, v1.0 (document owner Shyam Prasad).
DATE NOTE	the source gives Date Completed 25/07/2026 and Review Date 04/11/2025 – the review date is before the completion date and needs correcting by the assessor.

EQUIPMENT INFORMATION

Location	The Vedanta Kitchen & Retreat Centre
Assessor	Shyam Prasad
Brand	Caso
Model	Ice Creamer
Date Completed	25/07/2026
Review Date	04/11/2025 (see date note)

DESCRIPTION OF EQUIPMENT

A countertop ice cream / frozen dessert machine used to churn and freeze ice cream, sorbet and similar products for catering and retreat service.

OPERATING PROCEDURE (HOW TO USE)

1. Position the machine on a stable, ventilated surface away from heat sources.
2. Ensure the freezing bowl / canister is correctly pre-frozen or pre-chilled as per the manual.
3. Assemble the paddle, lid and bowl securely before switching on.
4. Prepare mix to the correct recipe and temperature; do not overfill the bowl.
5. Start the machine and supervise during churning; do not leave unattended for long periods.
6. Do not insert hands or utensils into the bowl while the paddle is moving.
7. Switch off before removing the paddle or scraping the finished product.
8. Transfer product with clean utensils into sanitised containers and store under correct temperature control.
9. Clean all food-contact parts after use and dry thoroughly before storage.

RISK ASSESSMENT

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Finger entrapment in paddle	Staff	Keep hands clear while running; switch off before scraping or removing paddle.	**High** before → **Low** after
Cold burns / freezer bowl handling	Staff	Handle frozen canister with dry cloths or gloves; do not touch with wet hands.	Medium before → **Low** after
Electrical shock	Staff	Keep cable and controls dry; inspect before use; unplug before cleaning.	Medium before → **Low** after
Slips from spilled mix	Staff	Wipe spills immediately; keep floor clear around machine.	Medium before → **Low** after

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Food contamination / temperature abuse	Guests / Staff	Use clean utensils; chill finished product promptly; follow shelf-life and HACCP controls.	**High** before → **Low** after

REQUIRED PPE

- Apron
- Non-slip footwear
- Protective gloves when handling frozen canisters

STAFF SIGN-OFF – I HAVE READ AND UNDERSTOOD THIS ASSESSMENT

#	Name	Signature	Date
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

Risk Assessment – Ninja Hand Blender

Source	Vedanta Combined Equipment & Kitchen Risk Assessments pack, v1.0 (document owner Shyam Prasad).
DATE NOTE	the source gives Date Completed 25/07/2026 and Review Date 04/11/2025 – the review date is before the completion date and needs correcting by the assessor.

EQUIPMENT INFORMATION

Location	The Vedanta Kitchen & Retreat Centre
Assessor	Shyam Prasad
Brand	Ninja
Model	Hand Blender
Date Completed	25/07/2026
Review Date	04/11/2025 (see date note)

DESCRIPTION OF EQUIPMENT

A handheld immersion blender used for pureeing soups, sauces, dressings and soft mixtures directly in pans or containers.

OPERATING PROCEDURE (HOW TO USE)

1. Check the blender shaft, blade guard and cable before use; do not use if damaged.
2. Ensure the pan or jug is stable and only partially filled to avoid splash-over.
3. Fully immerse the blade guard in the food before switching on.
4. Start on a low speed and keep the head submerged while blending.
5. Never blend with the blade above the liquid surface or near the rim of a shallow pan.
6. Do not insert fingers or utensils near the blade while powered.
7. Switch off and unplug before removing the shaft or cleaning the blade.
8. Allow hot liquids to cool slightly where practical to reduce splash risk.
9. Wash detachable parts, sanitise, dry and store with blade guard protected.

RISK ASSESSMENT

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Blade cuts	Staff	Keep hands clear; unplug before cleaning; store with guard / cover.	**High** before → **Low** after
Hot liquid splash / burns	Staff	Immerse fully before starting; blend gently; use tall containers where possible.	**High** before → **Low** after
Electrical shock	Staff	Keep motor body dry; never immerse the handle; inspect cable.	Medium before → **Low** after
Dropped appliance / impact injury	Staff	Use two hands for deep pans; dry grip; do not stretch cables across walkways.	Medium before → **Low** after

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Food contamination	Guests / Staff	Clean and sanitise shaft and blade after each use; avoid cross-contamination.	**High** before → **Low** after

REQUIRED PPE

- Apron
- Non-slip footwear
- Cut-resistant glove recommended when washing the blade

STAFF SIGN-OFF – I HAVE READ AND UNDERSTOOD THIS ASSESSMENT

#	Name	Signature	Date
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

Risk Assessment – KitchenAid Professional Stand Mixer

Source	Vedanta Combined Equipment & Kitchen Risk Assessments pack, v1.0 (document owner Shyam Prasad).
DATE NOTE	the source gives Date Completed 25/07/2026 and Review Date 04/11/2025 – the review date is before the completion date and needs correcting by the assessor.

EQUIPMENT INFORMATION

Location	The Vedanta Kitchen & Retreat Centre
Assessor	Shyam Prasad
Brand	KitchenAid
Model	Professional Stand Mixer
Date Completed	25/07/2026
Review Date	04/11/2025 (see date note)

DESCRIPTION OF EQUIPMENT

A heavy-duty stand mixer used for mixing doughs, batters, creams and other food ingredients. Commonly used for bakery and catering production.

OPERATING PROCEDURE (HOW TO USE)

1. Ensure the mixer is placed on a stable, dry surface before use.
2. Attach the correct tool (dough hook, whisk or flat beater) and lock the bowl securely.
3. Add ingredients carefully; do not exceed the recommended bowl capacity.
4. Start the mixer on the lowest speed and increase gradually as needed.
5. Never insert hands, spatulas or utensils into the bowl while the mixer is operating.
6. Stop the mixer completely before scraping the bowl or changing tools.
7. Unplug the mixer before cleaning or removing attachments.
8. Clean all food-contact parts thoroughly after each use.
9. Store attachments safely when not in use.

RISK ASSESSMENT

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Finger entrapment	Staff	Keep hands away from moving parts; ensure mixer is off when changing tools.	**High** before → **Low** after
Electrical shock	Staff	Inspect cables; keep hands dry; unplug before cleaning.	Medium before → **Low** after
Cuts from whisk or hook edges	Staff	Handle attachments carefully; unplug before removal.	Medium before → **Low** after
Mixer movement during heavy loads	Staff	Ensure stable surface; supervise during thick dough mixing.	Medium before → **Low** after

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Food contamination	Guests / Staff	Clean thoroughly; sanitise food-contact parts; follow HACCP.	**High** before → **Low** after

REQUIRED PPE

- Apron
- Non-slip footwear
- Heat-resistant gloves (when working with warm mixtures)

STAFF SIGN-OFF – I HAVE READ AND UNDERSTOOD THIS ASSESSMENT

#	Name	Signature	Date
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

Risk Assessment – Waring Stick Blender

Source	Vedanta Combined Equipment & Kitchen Risk Assessments pack, v1.0 (document owner Shyam Prasad).
DATE NOTE	the source gives Date Completed 25/07/2026 and Review Date 04/11/2025 – the review date is before the completion date and needs correcting by the assessor.

EQUIPMENT INFORMATION

Location	The Vedanta Kitchen & Retreat Centre
Assessor	Shyam Prasad
Brand	Waring
Model	Stick / Immersion Blender
Date Completed	25/07/2026
Review Date	04/11/2025 (see date note)

DESCRIPTION OF EQUIPMENT

A commercial stick blender used for blending soups, sauces and large-batch liquids in pots and deep containers within the kitchen.

OPERATING PROCEDURE (HOW TO USE)

1. Inspect the shaft, blade, switch and power cable before each use.
2. Place the pot on a stable surface; do not overfill.
3. Immerse the blade fully before switching on.
4. Hold the blender with a firm grip; support the pot if needed.
5. Blend at controlled speed to avoid splash-back of hot liquids.
6. Never place hands near the blade while the unit is plugged in.
7. Switch off and unplug before dismantling or washing.
8. Clean immediately after use; sanitise food-contact surfaces.
9. Store hanging or in a designated safe location with blade protected.

RISK ASSESSMENT

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Severe blade cuts	Staff	Unplug before cleaning; never leave plugged-in blender unattended in a pot; use blade cover in storage.	**High** before → **Low** after
Hot liquid burns / splash	Staff	Start submerged; use deep pots; reduce speed for hot liquids.	**High** before → **Low** after
Electrical shock	Staff	Keep motor housing dry; check cable integrity; RCD-protected circuits where available.	Medium before → **Low** after
Musculoskeletal strain	Staff	Use correct posture; avoid extended one-handed use; take breaks on large batches.	Medium before → **Low** after

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Food contamination	Guests / Staff	Clean and sanitise after each product; follow allergen and HACCP controls.	**High** before → **Low** after

REQUIRED PPE

- Apron
- Non-slip footwear
- Cut-resistant glove when washing blades

ADDITIONAL NOTES

STAFF SIGN-OFF – I HAVE READ AND UNDERSTOOD THIS ASSESSMENT

#	Name	Signature	Date
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

Risk Assessment – Knives, Mandoline, Slicers & Peelers

Source	Vedanta Combined Equipment & Kitchen Risk Assessments pack, v1.0 (document owner Shyam Prasad).
DATE NOTE	the source gives Date Completed 25/07/2026 and Review Date 04/11/2025 – the review date is before the completion date and needs correcting by the assessor.

EQUIPMENT INFORMATION

Location	The Vedanta Kitchen & Retreat Centre
Assessor	Shyam Prasad
Brand	Various
Model	Chef knives, mandoline, slicers and peelers
Date Completed	25/07/2026
Review Date	04/11/2025 (see date note)

DESCRIPTION OF EQUIPMENT

Hand tools and small cutting equipment used for preparation of fruit, vegetables and other ingredients. This section merges the Knives/Mandoline/Peelers and Knives/Slicers/Peelers assessments into one procedure.

OPERATING PROCEDURE (HOW TO USE)

1. Select the correct knife or tool for the task; check blades are clean and undamaged.
2. Use a stable chopping board with a non-slip mat underneath.
3. Keep fingers curled and clear of the blade path (claw grip).
4. For mandoline / slicers: always use the hand guard or cut-resistant glove; never push product by hand.
5. Cut away from the body; do not catch falling knives — let them drop.
6. Wash knives individually; never leave blades loose in sinks under water.
7. Store knives in a knife block, magnetic strip or sheath — not loose in drawers.
8. Sharpen / hone as required; a dull blade increases slip risk.
9. Report damaged tools and remove from service.

RISK ASSESSMENT

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Cuts / lacerations from knives	Staff	Training on safe knife skills; claw grip; cut-resistant gloves for high-risk tasks; safe storage.	**High** before → **Low** after
Severe cuts from mandoline / slicer	Staff	Mandatory use of guard or cut-resistant glove; dismantle carefully for cleaning.	**High** before → **Low** after

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Cross-contamination (raw / allergens)	Guests / Staff	Colour-coded boards and knives; wash between products; follow HACCP and allergen matrix.	**High** before → **Low** after
Slips from peelings / waste on floor	Staff	Clear waste regularly; wipe floors; use non-slip footwear.	Medium before → **Low** after
Incorrect tool storage injuries	Staff	Sheaths / magnetic strip / designated knife area; never leave in sinks.	Medium before → **Low** after

REQUIRED PPE

- Apron
- Non-slip footwear
- Cut-resistant gloves for mandoline, slicer and high-volume prep

STAFF SIGN-OFF – I HAVE READ AND UNDERSTOOD THIS ASSESSMENT

#	Name	Signature	Date
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

Risk Assessment – Vedanta Kitchen

Source	Vedanta Combined Equipment & Kitchen Risk Assessments pack, v1.0 (document owner Shyam Prasad).
DATE NOTE	the source gives Date Completed 25/07/2026 and Review Date 04/11/2025 – the review date is before the completion date and needs correcting by the assessor.

SCOPE

Covers general kitchen operations including food preparation, cooking, cleaning, storage, waste handling and staff movement within The Vedanta Kitchen.

KEY INFORMATION

Location	The Vedanta Kitchen & Retreat Centre
Assessor	Shyam Prasad
Assessment type	Area / activity risk assessment
Date Completed	25/07/2026
Review Date	04/11/2025 (see date note)

RISK ASSESSMENT

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Slips, trips and falls	Staff / Visitors	Clean spills immediately; clear walkways; non-slip mats; suitable footwear.	**High** before → **Low** after
Burns from ovens, hobs, hot pans	Staff	Use dry cloths / gloves; announce “hot”; keep pan handles turned inward.	**High** before → **Low** after
Fire (oil, electrical, gas)	Staff / Guests	Never leave fryers/pans unattended; know extinguisher types; fire training; extract cleaning.	**High** before → **Low** after
Manual handling injuries	Staff	Team lifts for heavy stock; use trolleys; training on safe lifting.	Medium before → **Low** after
Food poisoning / contamination	Guests	Temperature control; date labelling; cleaning schedules; allergen controls; HACCP.	**High** before → **Low** after
Chemical exposure (cleaners)	Staff	COSHH sheets; correct dilution; PPE; store chemicals away from food.	Medium before → **Low** after

CONTROL SUMMARY

- Maintain daily opening/closing cleaning checklists.
- Record fridge/freezer temperatures at required intervals.
- Keep first-aid kit and burn gel accessible.
- Report all near-misses and incidents.

REQUIRED PPE

- Apron / chef whites
- Non-slip footwear
- Heat-resistant gloves / cloths as needed
- Gloves for cleaning chemicals

STAFF SIGN-OFF – I HAVE READ AND UNDERSTOOD THIS ASSESSMENT

#	Name	Signature	Date
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

Risk Assessment – Vedanta Catering Services

Source	Vedanta Combined Equipment & Kitchen Risk Assessments pack, v1.0 (document owner Shyam Prasad).
DATE NOTE	the source gives Date Completed 25/07/2026 and Review Date 04/11/2025 – the review date is before the completion date and needs correcting by the assessor.

SCOPE

Covers off-site and on-site catering service: transport of food, service set-up, hot holding, buffet/service lines, and breakdown.

KEY INFORMATION

Location	The Vedanta Kitchen & Retreat Centre
Assessor	Shyam Prasad
Assessment type	Area / activity risk assessment
Date Completed	25/07/2026
Review Date	04/11/2025 (see date note)

RISK ASSESSMENT

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Temperature abuse during transport	Guests	Use insulated boxes; hot-hold above 63°C or cold below 5°C; temperature logs.	**High** before → **Low** after
Vehicle loading injuries / traffic risk	Staff	Use trolleys; secure loads; park safely; two-person lifts for heavy items.	Medium before → **Low** after
Burns / hot holding equipment	Staff	Warn guests/staff of hot surfaces; use correct lids and gloves.	Medium before → **Low** after
Allergen cross-contact at service	Guests	Clear allergen labelling; separate utensils; trained service staff; guest enquiry process.	**High** before → **Low** after
Slips at service points	Staff / Guests	Manage cable runs; wipe spills; clear guest walkways.	Medium before → **Low** after

CONTROL SUMMARY

- Complete a service checklist before departure and on arrival.
- Keep probe thermometer and sanitising wipes with the catering kit.
- Return leftovers under temperature control or dispose per food safety policy.

REQUIRED PPE

- Apron / service uniform
- Non-slip footwear
- Heat-resistant gloves for hot equipment

- Disposable gloves for ready-to-eat service where required

STAFF SIGN-OFF – I HAVE READ AND UNDERSTOOD THIS ASSESSMENT

#	Name	Signature	Date
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

Risk Assessment – Front of House & Kitchen

Source	Vedanta Combined Equipment & Kitchen Risk Assessments pack, v1.0 (document owner Shyam Prasad).
DATE NOTE	the source gives Date Completed 25/07/2026 and Review Date 04/11/2025 – the review date is before the completion date and needs correcting by the assessor.

SCOPE

Covers interaction between front-of-house and kitchen areas: service pass, guest areas, beverage service, and shared walkways during service periods.

KEY INFORMATION

Location	The Vedanta Kitchen & Retreat Centre
Assessor	Shyam Prasad
Assessment type	Area / activity risk assessment
Date Completed	25/07/2026
Review Date	04/11/2025 (see date note)

RISK ASSESSMENT

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
Collision in pass / corridor	Staff	Keep-left / call-outs (“behind”, “hot”); keep floors clear; limit congestion.	Medium before → **Low** after
Hot plate / spill burns at pass	Staff	Use dry cloths; communicate plate status; stable stacking.	Medium before → **Low** after
Guest slips in dining areas	Guests / Staff	Prompt spill response; suitable mats at entrances; clear trailing cables.	Medium before → **Low** after
Broken glass / crockery	Staff / Guests	Clear immediately with dustpan; dispose in glass bin; cordon if needed.	Medium before → **Low** after
Allergen information failure	Guests	Up-to-date allergen matrix; FOH trained to check with kitchen; never guess.	**High** before → **Low** after

CONTROL SUMMARY

- FOH and kitchen brief before busy service.
- Keep emergency exits and fire routes clear at all times.
- Ensure allergen folder / matrix is current for the day’s menu.

REQUIRED PPE

- Non-slip footwear
- Service apron where required
- Gloves for clearing waste / glass

STAFF SIGN-OFF – I HAVE READ AND UNDERSTOOD THIS ASSESSMENT

#	Name	Signature	Date
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

Risk Assessment – Generic Kitchen (June 2024 basis)

Source	Vedanta Combined Equipment & Kitchen Risk Assessments pack, v1.0 (document owner Shyam Prasad).
DATE NOTE	the source gives Date Completed 25/07/2026 and Review Date 04/11/2025 – the review date is before the completion date and needs correcting by the assessor.

SCOPE

General kitchen hazards and standard controls for The Vedanta Kitchen & Retreat Centre, based on the June 2024 generic kitchen risk assessment. Use alongside equipment-specific sheets.

KEY INFORMATION

Location	The Vedanta Kitchen & Retreat Centre
Assessor	Shyam Prasad
Assessment type	Area / activity risk assessment
Date Completed	25/07/2026
Review Date	04/11/2025 (see date note)

RISK ASSESSMENT

Hazard	Who	Controls	Risk
General kitchen injury (cuts, burns, strains)	Staff	Induction training; supervision of new staff; safe systems of work; PPE.	**High** before → **Low** after
Electrical equipment faults	Staff	Visual checks before use; PAT testing schedule; remove defective kit from service.	Medium before → **Low** after
Poor housekeeping	Staff / Guests	Clean-as-you-go; end-of-day deep clean; designated storage for tools and stock.	Medium before → **Low** after
Pest activity	Guests / Staff	Seal food; waste control; report sightings; pest contractor visits.	Medium before → **Low** after
Inadequate first aid response	Staff / Guests	Trained first aiders; stocked kit; incident reporting forms available.	Medium before → **Low** after

CONTROL SUMMARY

- Review this generic assessment whenever menus, staffing or layout change.
- Keep SDS / COSHH information accessible for all cleaning chemicals.
- Link this pack to staff induction and refresher training records.

REQUIRED PPE

- Apron
- Non-slip footwear

- Task-specific gloves (heat, cut, chemical)

ADDITIONAL NOTES

- Where an equipment sheet and this generic sheet both apply, follow the stricter control.

STAFF SIGN-OFF – I HAVE READ AND UNDERSTOOD THIS ASSESSMENT

#	Name	Signature	Date
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			